

Topic 10: AI for Email and Communication

10.1 AI Email Drafting

- AI can draft professional emails in seconds from brief bullet-point instructions
- Provide: recipient context, your relationship, the purpose, key points to include, tone, and desired length
- Tools available: ChatGPT / Claude (paste and refine), Gmail 'Help me write' (Gemini), Outlook Copilot
- Best practice: draft with AI, then personalise -- add specific details, the recipient's name, and any inside references
- Strong use cases: difficult conversations, cold outreach, follow-ups, proposals, and complaint responses

Email drafting prompt:

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'Draft a polite but firm follow-up to a supplier who missed a delivery deadline.
We have been waiting 2 weeks. We need delivery by Friday or will cancel.
Tone: professional, not angry.
Include a clear call to action with a specific deadline.
Length: under 100 words.'
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10.2 AI for Email Management

- Gmail Gemini: summarises long email threads into key points; drafts replies in your style
- Outlook Copilot: summarises threads, drafts replies, and identifies action items from emails
- Superhuman (superhuman.com): AI email client with instant AI summaries and one-click reply suggestions
- SaneBox (sanebox.com): uses ML to filter and prioritise your inbox automatically (not generative AI but very effective)
- Goal: reduce reactive email processing to focused batches rather than constant interruption

10.3 AI for Slack and Teams

- Slack AI (paid add-on): summarises long channel threads; answers questions about past conversations
- Microsoft Teams Copilot: summarises chat threads, catches you up on missed messages, drafts replies
- ChatGPT in Slack: add as a bot app; ask questions and get AI assistance directly within Slack channels

- Limitation: AI summaries can miss tone, politics, and nuance -- always read critical messages yourself
- Use case: 'Summarise what was decided in #product-decisions this week and list any open questions'

10.4 Tone and Sensitivity in AI Communications

- Ask AI to adjust tone: 'Make this more assertive', 'Make this warmer and less formal', 'Cut this by 40%'
 - Sensitive messages: AI helps structure difficult communications (performance feedback, rejections, complaints)
 - Always review AI-drafted messages for personal details only you can know -- AI cannot read the relationship dynamics
 - Cultural sensitivity: phrasing appropriate in one culture can be inappropriate in another -- localise and review
 - Legal communications: never send AI-drafted legal notices, contracts, or compliance documents without expert review
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